

Build an app that feels considered.

Practical guidance and a ready-to-use prompt for an AI agent, from a polished Material 3 interface to layouts that adapt across Android devices.

01 Principles of modern Android design

Start with the user's task

Before designing screens, identify the primary action, the most common user journeys, and what people need to notice first. Reduce visual noise; provide one primary action for each context.

Use Material 3 as a system

Build on Material 3 components, typography and color scales, and consistent shapes and spacing. Create a small design system with tokens instead of mixing styles at random.

Design for light and dark themes

Use semantic colors and check contrast, readability, and component states in both themes. Never rely on color alone to communicate meaning.

Adapt the interface to available space

Show focused content on phones. On tablets, foldables, or wide windows, change the layout—for example, show a list and its details side by side. Do not simply stretch a mobile screen.

Make accessibility part of the design

Use clear copy, readable contrast, support for larger text, descriptive screen-reader labels, and generous touch targets. Key actions should make sense without relying on color.

Design the whole experience

Include empty, loading, success, and error states; feedback after actions; predictable navigation; and preservation of user input when returning to a screen.

Quick visual checks

Consistent spacing rhythm • one clear primary action per view • balanced visual hierarchy • icons only when recognizable • avoid generic cards around every element.

02 Prompt to give your agent

Copy the text below and fill in the brackets. If the agent can access your repository, ask it to inspect the existing structure and follow the project's technology choices.

Role

You are an experienced Android product designer and UI engineer. Create a polished, modern, coherent Android experience for [app name and purpose]. The primary users are [audience]; the most important task they need to complete is [task].

Before implementation

Inspect the existing project, technologies, and conventions. Summarize the key user journeys and propose a screen structure. Do not change the platform or architecture without a good reason. If details are missing, state reasonable assumptions and proceed.

Visual direction

Use Android-native patterns and Material 3 components. Establish a coherent system for color, typography, spacing, and shapes. The interface should feel clear, warm, and contemporary, with strong hierarchy and enough breathing room. Avoid clutter, decorative gradients without purpose, and cards that do not help group content.

Interaction and content

Give each screen one primary action. Use clear labels, expected Android navigation, and visible feedback. Handle loading, empty results, errors, success, and offline states. Preserve user input where it makes sense.

Adaptability and accessibility

Support light and dark themes, system insets, and different text sizes. Ensure readable contrast, accessible labels, and generous touch targets. Adapt the layout to available width: phone, landscape, tablet, and foldable. Use extra width meaningfully with a multi-pane layout.

Delivery quality

Implement functional flows, not just a static mockup. Reuse components, use realistic sample content, and remove placeholder copy. Check layouts on small and large screens and in both themes. At the end, summarize what changed, assumptions made, and anything still incomplete.

Project constraints

[e.g. Kotlin + Jetpack Compose / existing XML UI; APIs; timeline; brand; what must not change]

03 Pre-delivery checklist

☐ Hierarchy

Is it immediately clear where I am, what I can do, and what matters most?

☐ Consistency

Do screens share the same tokens, components, labels, and behaviors?

☐ States

Are empty data, loading, errors, success, and offline states covered?

☐ Adaptability

Does the interface remain usable on rotation, resized windows, and tablets?

☐ Accessibility

Does larger text work? Are icons labeled? Are text and controls readable?

☐ Android behavior

Do Back navigation, system insets, and touch targets feel natural on Android?

☐ Polish

Are spacing and copy considered, with clear transitions and feedback?

Official sources for further reading

This brief summarizes recommendations. Use the official documentation as the authoritative source for implementation details.

- [Material Design 3](https://m3.material.io/)

- [Android Design: adapt mobile layouts](https://developer.android.com/design/ui/mobile/guides/layout-and-content/adapt-layout)

- [Android: get started with adaptive apps](https://developer.android.com/develop/adaptive-apps/guides/get-started-with-adaptive-apps)

- [Android: core app quality guidelines](https://developer.android.com/develop/adaptive-apps/quality-guidelines/core-app-quality)

- [Android: navigation](https://developer.android.com/guide/navigation/)

Prepared October 1, 2026. These general guidelines should be tailored to the app's actual purpose and existing project.